

IBM

IBM has been invested in AR from as long ago as 2010. Their collaboration with the Nokia Research Center as well as the Technical Research of Finland go as far back as this. In the more current form of AR, IBM has been investing in educational as well as marketable uses for their patents.

While collaborating with the New York Times' T Brand Studio, IBM worked closely on an AR experience inspired by the film *Hidden Figures*. The film tells the story of three African American female mathematicians who worked in NASA as early as the 1960s. The AR experience based on this film is called *Outthink Hidden*. It follows the story of these three unlikely heroes and their accomplishments in the fields of science, technology, engineering and maths.

The Israel branch of IBM's research team is developing AR utilities to improve the experience of real-time shopping. It is working on this project in association with Tesco to provide employees with solutions for better shelving, storage as well as product placement. When they have access to this technology, it lets them superimpose images on the shelves so that they can see what the final display will look like. Being able to do so without actually having to move any boxes, means that the retailer saves on production time as well as increases his/her efficiency.

IBM has always been a forerunner when it comes to adopting and backing tech advancement for enterprise use. With its interest in AR, the timing couldn't be better. At this very point in time, the number of people interested in AR is increasing by leaps and bounds. Almost everything in the average consumer's life is centred around their phones and tablets.

Alphabet, Inc.

This well known parent company of tech giant Google is perhaps arguably the most active middle man in the world of AR. Google Tango, their AR platform, has gained a huge advantage in the past year. It has seen active partnerships and collaborations from other tech giants like Asus, Lenovo, IBM, Gap Inc. to name a few.

The exclusivity factor that the Tango comes with has also helped with its popularity. For instance, BMW has developed a 3D AR visualizer that comes with their i3 as well as i8 units. The catch - these units are compatible with Tango-enabled devices exclusively. At the end of the day, these exclusive contracts mean a lot of revenue for the company.